MERIDIAN HARBOR LOGISTICS

Office of Information Technology · Assessment Engagement Packet
To: Northstar Security Assurance
Reference: MHL-NSA-100 · Revision 0.2 · Controlled copy

Letter of engagement

Meridian Harbor Logistics requests an assessment of the technology supporting our dispatch, customer shipment tracking, finance reporting, and recently acquired warehouse operation. Our next major customer requires assurance that customer records and internal business systems are appropriately protected.

Please assess the environment as a connected business. We need clear evidence of business impact, practical recommendations, and a prioritized remediation plan that our IT department can carry out. A list of scanner findings alone will not meet our objectives.

Company context

We coordinate regional freight and temperature-controlled deliveries. Dispatch staff rely on Windows domain accounts and shared documents; customers use a Linux-hosted shipment portal. Warehouse deployment and backup tooling was retained after an acquisition because replacing it would disrupt operations. Integration was performed under a tight schedule and documentation is uneven.

Points of contact

Contact	Responsibility	Contact channel
Evelyn Vale, Director of Technology	Executive sponsor and scope decisions	security@meridianharbor.example
Jonas Reed, Infrastructure Lead	Windows/domain and server operations	operations@meridianharbor.example
Mira Chen, Service Desk Lead	Assessment coordination and incident escalation	servicedesk@meridianharbor.example

Please use the engagement coordination channel supplied by the MHL service desk for routine questions, evidence transfer, and incident escalation.

Authorized environment

The scope register supplied with your account handover identifies the approved systems, application URLs, credentials, and assessment window. The internal Windows domain is `mhl.test`. Authorization applies only to assets named in that register; network connectivity alone does not expand the scope.

Company systems include MHL-DC01, MHL-FS01, MHL-DB01, MHL-APP01, MHL-CI01 and MHL-BKP01. The service desk provides access to assessment workstations through our remote-access gateway. The gateway and supporting infrastructure are outside scope unless separately authorized in writing.

Rules of engagement

- Assess only the assigned targets and supplied application URLs/accounts.
- Use controlled proofs of concept and the minimum records necessary to demonstrate impact; explain the attack conditions and resulting business risk.
- Preserve service availability and evidence. Coordinate before disruptive changes, account lockouts, bulk data changes, or persistence testing.
- Stop and report access to systems or data outside the approved scope register.
- Exclude denial of service, destructive encryption, uncontrolled malware, social engineering of real people, and attacks on public Internet systems.
- Exclude infrastructure and third-party services not listed in the scope register. Any proposed expansion requires written approval from MHL.

Requested deliverables

1. An executive summary describing material business risks.
2. A technical report with affected assets, reproducible evidence, realistic impact, severity rationale, and remediation.
3. A connected attack narrative where findings combine into greater impact.
4. A prioritized remediation roadmap, separating immediate containment from longer-term improvements.
5. A short technical handoff and executive briefing.

Use screenshots and minimal proof-of-concept artifacts where useful. Keep credentials out of general report copies and submit sensitive material through MHL's designated engagement channel. Include assumptions, limitations, and unverified findings explicitly.

Evelyn Vale
Director of Technology
Meridian Harbor Logistics